

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Painting Traditions - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Painting Traditions	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — PAINTING VOCABULARY AND ROCK ART Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning.
02	FOUNDATION — AJANTA'S DRY-PLASTER TECHNIQUE Mains: Use technique as a close-option discriminator.
03	FOUNDATION — BAGH AND HALLISALASYA Evidence chain: Bagh evidence Qualified use: Prepare the provisional
04	CORE — PALLAVA AND CHOLA MURAL SURVIVAL Evidence chain: Pallava mural survival - Chola mural record Qualified
05	CORE — FROM WALL TO PORTABLE PAGE Format change does not erase devotional continuity.
06	CORE — AKBAR'S COLLABORATIVE ATELIER Court style is collective workshop production.
07	CORE — JAHANGIR'S ALBUM AND NATURAL HISTORY Evidence chain: Jahangir shift Qualified use: Prepare the routed 2019
08	CORE — ARTIST MOBILITY AND REGIONAL SCHOOLS Evidence chain: Regional dispersal mechanism Qualified use: Explain
09	CORE — KISHANGARH AND BANI THANI Evidence chain: Kishangarh identification Qualified use: Prepare the
10	CORE — PAHARI AND DECCANI DISCRIMINATORS Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and
11	CORE — TANJORE AND MYSORE Evidence chain: Tanjore and Mysore Qualified use: Distinguish South
12	CORE — COMPANY, BAZAAR AND COLONIAL PUBLICS Evidence chain: Company and bazaar publics Qualified use: Connect
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — RAVI VARMA AND BENGAL SCHOOL Evidence chain: Company and bazaar publics - Ravi Varma transition -
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — FOLK AND TRIBAL PRODUCTION SYSTEMS Evidence chain: Folk-painting specificity Qualified use: Add

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Shadanga of painting?

A. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. B. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: A. Explanation: Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Shadanga of painting?

A. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. B. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. C. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: B. Explanation: Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Shadanga of painting?

A. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. B. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. C. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. D. Vijaya Cholishwaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: C. Explanation: Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Shadanga of painting?

A. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. B. Vijaya Cholishwaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. C. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. D. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Rock-art foundation?

A. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. B. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. C. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Rock-art foundation?

A. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. B. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rock-art foundation?

A. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. B. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rock-art foundation?

A. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. B. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. C. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. D. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Ajanta technique?

A. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. B. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasaya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Ajanta technique?

A. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. B. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. C. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. D. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ajanta technique?

A. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. B. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. C. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ajanta technique?

A. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. B. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. C. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Bagh evidence?

A. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. B. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Bagh evidence?

A. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. B. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. C. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. D. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Bagh evidence?

A. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. D. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Bagh evidence?

A. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. B. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. C. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. D. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Pallava mural survival?

A. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. B. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. C. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: A. Explanation: The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Pallava mural survival?

A. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. B. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. C. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. D. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.

Answer: B. Explanation: The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pallava mural survival?

A. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pallava mural survival?

A. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. D. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production.

Answer: D. Explanation: The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Chola mural record?

A. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. D. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.

Answer: A. Explanation: Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Chola mural record?

A. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. B. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. C. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. D. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.

Answer: B. Explanation: Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chola mural record?

A. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. B. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. C. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. D. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.

Answer: C. Explanation: Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chola mural record?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. C. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. D. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Answer: D. Explanation: Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Format-patronage relation?

A. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. D. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Format-patronage relation?

A. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. B. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. C. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. D. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Format-patronage relation?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. C. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. D. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Format-patronage relation?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. C. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. D. Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.

Answer: D. Explanation: Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Pala and Western Indian manuscripts?

A. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. B. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. C. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. D. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Pala and Western Indian manuscripts?

A. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. B. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. C. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. D. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pala and Western Indian manuscripts?

A. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. B. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. C. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pala and Western Indian manuscripts?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. C. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. D. Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Akbar atelier?

A. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. B. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. C. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. D. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.

Answer: A. Explanation: Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Akbar atelier?

A. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. B. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. C. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. D. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur.

Answer: B. Explanation: Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Akbar atelier?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. C. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Akbar atelier?

A. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. B. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. C. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. D. Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.

Answer: D. Explanation: Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Jahangir shift?

A. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. B. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. C. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. D. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Jahangir shift?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. C. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jahangir shift?

A. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. B. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. C. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jahangir shift?

A. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Regional dispersal mechanism?

A. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. B. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. C. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. D. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Regional dispersal mechanism?

A. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. B. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Regional dispersal mechanism?

A. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. D. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Regional dispersal mechanism?

A. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. B. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. C. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. D. Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Kishangarh identification?

A. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. B. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Kishangarh identification?

A. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. B. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. C. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. D. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kishangarh identification?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. C. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. D. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kishangarh identification?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. D. Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Pahari sequence?

A. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal.

Answer: A. Explanation: Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Pahari sequence?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.

Answer: B. Explanation: Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pahari sequence?

A. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. B. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. C. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. D. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.

Answer: C. Explanation: Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pahari sequence?

A. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. B. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. C. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. D. Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Deccani distinction?

A. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. B. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.

Answer: A. Explanation: Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Deccani distinction?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. C. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. D. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.

Answer: B. Explanation: Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Deccani distinction?

A. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. B. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. C. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. D. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics.

Answer: C. Explanation: Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Deccani distinction?

A. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. B. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal.

Answer: D. Explanation: Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Tanjore and Mysore?

A. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. D. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Tanjore and Mysore?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. C. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. D. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Tanjore and Mysore?

A. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. B. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. C. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. D. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Tanjore and Mysore?

A. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. B. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tanjore painting is identified by devotional icons, gesso relief and gold coating; Mysore is a distinct South Indian tradition and must not be treated as its synonym. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Company and bazaar publics?

A. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. B. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. C. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. D. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.

Answer: A. Explanation: Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Company and bazaar publics?

A. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. B. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.

Answer: B. Explanation: Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Company and bazaar publics?

A. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. B. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. C. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. D. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.

Answer: C. Explanation: Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Company and bazaar publics?

A. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. B. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.

Answer: D. Explanation: Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Ravi Varma transition?

A. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. B. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. C. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. D. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.

Answer: A. Explanation: Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Ravi Varma transition?

A. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. B. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ravi Varma transition?

A. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. B. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. C. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. D. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ravi Varma transition?

A. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. B. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics.

Answer: D. Explanation: Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Bengal School programme?

A. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. B. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Bengal School programme?

A. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. B. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Bengal School programme?

A. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. B. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. C. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: C. Explanation: Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Bengal School programme?

A. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. B. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. C. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. D. Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Folk-painting specificity?

A. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. B. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. C. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. D. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image.

Answer: A. Explanation: Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Folk-painting specificity?

A. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. B. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. C. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. D. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Folk-painting specificity?

A. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. B. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. C. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. D. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave.

Answer: C. Explanation: Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Folk-painting specificity?

A. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. B. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.

Answer: D. Explanation: Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Painting PYQ and live boundary?

A. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. B. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image. C. Roopbheda, Pramana, Bhava, Lavanya Yojana, Sadrishya and Varnikabhanga organise appearance, proportion, expression, composition, resemblance and brush-colour treatment. D. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.

Answer: A. Explanation: The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Painting PYQ and live boundary?

A. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. B. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. C. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. D. Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image.

Answer: B. Explanation: The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Painting PYQ and live boundary?

A. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. B. Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco. C. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. D. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave.

Answer: C. Explanation: The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Painting PYQ and live boundary?

A. Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara. B. Bagh lies on the Baghni river in Dhar district; Cave 4 is Rang Mahal, while Hallisalasya is attributed to Bagh paintings generally and not to a specified cave. C. The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production. D. The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

No direct GS-I Mains PYQ is routed to painting in the audited ledgers. The package retains the verified 2018 Bani Thani and 2019 Jahangir objective routes without inferring unavailable keys, and the 2026 Hallisalasya route without inferring its provisional answer.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests painting as a stand-alone topic.

FACT: This topic **supports** (does not own) the 2024 Q2 Pallava question and 2024 Q11 Chola question (topic 03) by supplying the mural-painting evidence (Pallava murals at Kanchipuram and Panamalai) relevant to a full "art and architecture" or "art and literature" answer on those dynasties.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	5	Hallisalasya painting and iconographic subject in the Bagh Caves	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Hallisalasya painting and iconographic subject in the Bagh Caves

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	42	Bani Thani painting and its Rajasthani school attribution	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	17	Mughal painting tradition shift to individual portraiture	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Bani Thani painting and its Rajasthani school attribution
- Mughal painting tradition shift to individual portraiture

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

8. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests painting. FACT: This topic's format-patronage argument (Section 1) strengthens a full answer to **2024 Q2** (Pallava contribution to "art and literature") by explaining why so little Pallava mural evidence survives without implying the tradition was minor, and strengthens **2024 Q11** (Chola "highest achievements... in art and architecture") by cross-referencing Chola-period mural fragments alongside the better-preserved bronze and stone sculptural record (topic 06).

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why survival bias matters when assessing Indian mural traditions. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The small Pallava and Chola survival record constrains quantity claims but cannot measure original production; named fragments, literary evidence and superimposed layers must be read together.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Ajanta pigments were generally applied after prepared plaster dried, so fresco secco or tempera is safer than calling the murals true wet fresco.
- The principal surviving Pallava mural locations are Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram and Talagishwara at Panamalai; survival scarcity is not proof of low original production.
- Vijaya Choliswaram and Brihadishvara preserve the principal Chola wall-painting record, with Rajaraja and Karuvur Devar and later Nayaka superimposition at Brihadishvara.

Qualified conclusion: The small Pallava and Chola survival record constrains quantity claims but cannot measure original production; named fragments, literary evidence and superimposed layers must be read together.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Akbar-era manuscript painting from Jahangir-era album painting. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The shift is from collaborative narrative manuscript series to refined album portraiture and natural history, reflecting a changed patronal gaze rather than a complete workshop rupture.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.
- Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.

Qualified conclusion: The shift is from collaborative narrative manuscript series to refined album portraiture and natural history, reflecting a changed patronal gaze rather than a complete workshop rupture.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the evolution of Indian painting through changes of format and audience. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Rock surface, cave and temple wall, manuscript, album, canvas and print each altered portability, patronage, subject and viewing public.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Bhimbetka and Lakhudiyar establish a prehistoric rock-art beginning, while a petroglyph is an engraving and must not be confused with a painted image.

- Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.
- Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage.
- Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.
- Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics.

Qualified conclusion: Rock surface, cave and temple wall, manuscript, album, canvas and print each altered portability, patronage, subject and viewing public.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare major Rajasthani, Pahari and Deccani miniature idioms. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Common miniature resources were regionally reworked through palette, line, theme and court ecology; Kishangarh, Basohli-Kangra and Deccani distinctions should be made on identical axes.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.
- Bani Thani belongs to the Kishangarh school and is associated with Nihal Chand; it must not be assigned to Kangra, Bundi or Jaipur.
- Basohli is marked by intense colour and bold line, while Guler and Kangra move toward softer naturalism and lyrical Krishna-poetry themes.
- Deccani miniatures use saturated colour, elongated figures and fantastic landscapes within Persianate-Deccan court culture; shared Persian roots do not make them Mughal.

Qualified conclusion: Common miniature resources were regionally reworked through palette, line, theme and court ecology; Kishangarh, Basohli-Kangra and Deccani distinctions should be made on identical axes.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the relationship between patronage and stylistic change in Indian painting. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Institutional mural sponsorship, monastic manuscript production, imperial karkhanas, regional courts, colonial commissions and nationalist publics successively changed format and subject without creating sealed traditions.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Monumental murals require architectural sponsorship and collective viewing, whereas portable manuscripts and albums enable smaller royal or elite commissions and regional dispersal.
- Pala Buddhist and Western Indian or Jain manuscript traditions precede Mughal miniatures and preserve devotional page-based painting under monastic and mercantile patronage.
- Akbar's karkhana produced large illustrated manuscripts through collaborative labour by artists drawn from multiple regions and religious backgrounds.
- Jahangir-era painting emphasised album pages, individual portraiture and natural history, with Mansur associated with flora-fauna observation.
- Reduced imperial patronage and artist mobility helped regional Rajasthani and Pahari centres adapt shared miniature resources rather than develop as sealed ethnic styles.
- Company painting served colonial patrons and documentation, whereas bazaar and Kalighat production addressed pilgrimage and commercial publics; neither is a single uniform school.
- Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.

Qualified conclusion: Institutional mural sponsorship, monastic manuscript production, imperial karkhanas, regional courts, colonial commissions and nationalist publics successively changed format and subject without creating sealed traditions.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss modern, folk and tribal painting as living cultural systems. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Ravi Varma, the Bengal School and community traditions show different relations among technique, market, ritual, nationalism and institutions; protection cannot reduce them to decorative survivals.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Raja Ravi Varma applied European academic realism to Indian mythological subjects and expanded their print circulation, creating the immediate contrast used by Bengal School critics.
- Abanindranath Tagore's Bengal School used wash, subdued colour and Ajanta, Mughal and Rajasthani resources as a nationalist reaction to colonial and academic idioms.
- Madhubani, Warli, Pattachitra, Kalamkari, Gond, Phad and Thangka differ by region, support, community, ritual function and market; folk and tribal are not homogeneous labels.
- The verified routes are objective demands on Bani Thani, Jahangir-era portraiture and provisional Hallisalasya; Lalit Kala Akademi's 2025 exhibition is a living institutional link, not historical-style evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Ravi Varma, the Bengal School and community traditions show different relations among technique, market, ritual, nationalism and institutions; protection cannot reduce them to decorative survivals.